THE COST OF BUSINESS SKILLS

Average fee for the entire course charged by B-schools

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE COURSE FEES
TOP 1-25	₹20,17,728
TOP 26-50	₹14,13,556
TOP 51-75	₹11,38,170
TOP 76-100	₹7,58,663

Government vs private

(Among top-100 B-schools)

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE COURSE FEE
GOVERNMENT	₹14,12,828
PRIVATE	₹13,11,815

Zone-wise

(Among top-100 B-schools)

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE COURSE FEE
EAST	₹16,36,068
NORTH	₹12,13,172
SOUTH	₹12,10,244
WEST	₹14,46,074

City-wise

(Among top-100 B-schools)

CATEGORY OF B-SCHOOLS	AVERAGE COURSE FEES
DELHI-NCR	₹11,54,880
MUMBAI	₹15,69,051
BENGALURU	₹10,79,316
PUNE	₹14,55,979
HYDERABAD	₹13,36,200
KOLKATA	₹15,76,667

TOP 10 B-SCHOOLS OFFERING ONLINE COURSES

RANK	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	CITY	OVERALL SCORE (1,000)
1	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT AHMEDABAD	Ahmedabad	846.5
2	MANAGEMENT DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE	Gurugram	834.8
3	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT MUMBAI	Mumbai	821.0
4	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF FOREIGN TRADE	New Delhi	818.8
5	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT UDAIPUR	Udaipur	797.5
6	S. P. JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT & RESEARCH	Mumbai	793.3
7	SVKM'S NMIMS, SCHOOL OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT	Mumbai	781.5
8	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT NAGPUR	Nagpur	780.0
9	INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT TECHNOLOGY, GHAZIABAD	Ghaziabad	775.5
10	INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT BODH GAYA	Bodh Gaya	772.3

Note: Only two-year online or blended programmes offered by B-schools and leading to a master's or postgraduate degree/diploma have been included in this table. Though institutes use different titles—including 'Executive MBA'—these programmes are essentially designed for learners who want an MBA-equivalent qualification without attending on-campus classes. While some programmes mandate prior work experience, others do not require it.

nally learned to play the long game. TAPMI, KJ Somaiya, Great Lakes, BIMTECH, SDMIMD, and Welingkar are not climbing because they have tightened academic processes, embraced AI-integrated learning systems, invested in faculty development and strengthened their corporate outreach. This is the rise of a new middle order, a group of institutions that are turning themselves into credible, future-ready schools capable of challenging traditional elites.

A new middle order is rising, institutions capable of challenging the traditional elites

Value of a degree

Fees for the top government and top private B-schools are now nearly indistinguishable. The average fee for government schools in the top 100 gently surpasses that of private institutions, driven primarily by the IIMs adopting market-aligned tuition structures. What this does is refocus attention on RoI. If a student is going to spend upwards of Rs 20 lakh on a management education, they are no longer choosing on the basis of brand alone, they are evaluating the ratio of investment to outcome. This year, RoI champions emerge from unexpected pockets: MS University of Baroda, Delhi University's Business Economics Department, Tezpur University, and smaller private institutions in Tamil Nadu or Chhattisgarh that combine modest fees with respectable placements. The RoI list becomes a counter-narrative, an alternative map for aspirants who prioritise value over vanity.

One of the survey's fascinating insights is how geography shapes outcomes. Mumbai, for decades the nerve